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3.1 MAGNETISM - INTRODUCTION

Magnetism is a force field that acts on some materials. A physical device which possesses this force is called as a magnet.

The force to attract iron is known as Magnetism. The substance which possesses magnetism is called Magnet. The materials attracted by a magnet are known as Magnetic materials.

Magnetism plays an important role in electricity. Without the aid of magnet, it is impossible to operate devices like generator, electric motors, transformers, electrical instruments, etc. Magnetism is also used in the functioning of radio, television, phones and ignition system of auto mobiles. In this chapter salient features of magnetism and function of magnetism in the electrical equipment are explained.

3.2 PROPERTIES OF MAGNETS

- Magnets attract magnetic substances such as iron, nickel, cobalt and its alloy.
- If a magnet is freely suspended, its pole will always tend to set themselves in the direction of north and south.
- Like poles repels and unlike poles attracts each other.

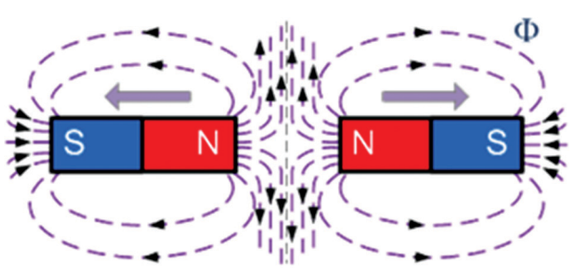


Fig 3.1 *Like Poles*

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